Nikhil Rao

CONTACT

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EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research 2025–Present

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of Michigan 2025
M.A., Economics, University of Michigan 2021
B.A., Economics & Mathematics, University of Massachusetts Amherst 2015

FIELDS

Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

"The Socioeconomic Consequences of Misdemeanor Conviction", with James Reeves.
"Measuring Discrimination using Natural Experiments", with James Reeves.
"Network Spillovers and the Social Returns to Crime-Reduction Interventions", with Ashley Craig, Sara Heller, and Kenneth Hofmeister.
"Parental Resources and College Major Choice", with Zsigmond Pálvölgyi & Tyler Radler.

IN PROGRESS

"Peer Socioeconomic Mismatch and Student Achievement", with Micah Y. Baum.
"Examining Interventions to Improve Outcomes of Justice-involved Individuals", with James Reeves.

PUBLICATIONS

"Inflation Expectations and Nonlinearities in the Phillips Curve", with Alexander Doser, Ricardo Nunes and Viacheslav Sheremirov. *Journal of Applied Econometrics* 38:4 (2023), 453-471.
"Sectoral inflation and the Phillips curve: What has changed since the Great Recession?", with Maria Jose Luengo-Prado and Viacheslav Sheremirov. *Economics Letters* 172 (2018), 63–68.

EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2026 *(including upcoming)*

George Washington University	Washington, DC
Linnaeus University	Växjö, Sweden
Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime	Ithaca, NY
Opportunity Insights Conference on Economic Mobility	Cambridge, MA
Georgetown University	Washington, DC
CJARS 10-Year Anniversary Conference	Ann Arbor, MI
NBER SI (Law & Economics, Crime)	Cambridge, MA
Policy Impacts Annual Conference	Cambridge, MA
Federal Reserve Bank of Boston	Boston, MA

2025

Tufts University Brownbag	Medford, MA
Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars	Philadelphia, PA
University of Colorado	Denver, CO

2024

Southern Economic Association Meeting	Washington, DC
Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management Fall Conference	National Harbor, MD
Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime	Zurich, Switzerland

	Western Economic Association Conference	Seattle, WA
	Texas Economics of Crime Workshop	Austin, TX
	2019	
	Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting	Lansing, MI

Awards & Fellowships

Policy Impacts Early Career Scholars Grant	2026
Department of Economics Fellowship	2025
Rackham One Term Dissertation Fellowship	2024
Rackham Conference Travel Grant	2024 (x2)
Department of Economics Conference Travel Grant	2019; 2024 (x2)
Poverty Solutions One Term Fellowship	2023
Department of Economics Research Grant	2022; 2023
Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship	2018–2019

Teaching

University of Michigan

Economics of the Population (ECON 466)	Fall 2020
Introductory Macroeconomics (ECON 102)	Winter 2020
Introductory Microeconomics (ECON 101)	Fall 2019

Research Experience & Employment

University of Michigan

Graduate Research Assistant to Ashley Craig & Sara Heller	2020–2024
Summer Research Assistant to Ana Reynoso	2020
Summer Research Assistant to Lauren Falcao Bergquist	2019

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston

Senior Research Assistant, Jenny Tang & Viacheslav Sheremirov	2015–2018

Service

Referee: *American Law and Economics Review*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*

Graduate Program Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2021–2022
Admissions Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2020–2021
Social Chair, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2019–2020

Other

Analytics and Programming: Stata, R, Matlab and LaTeX
Clearance: U.S. Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status
Citizenship: USA

References

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Michael Mueller-Smith
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